STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS PHASE

1. Introduction

The project aims to streamline the IT procurement process by automating Standard Laptop orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The requirement analysis identifies the functions and components needed to create an automated workflow that generates and assigns a Catalog Task after the required approval process. This helps reduce manual intervention, waiting time and possible delays in laptop configuration.

2. Problem Analysis

The existing IT procurement process involves manual activities that can lead to delays and additional workload. Standard laptop configurations may require manual task creation and assignment, which can result in waiting time and possible oversights.

Therefore, an automated process is required to streamline Standard Laptop ordering and configuration.

3. User Requirements

The IT procurement team requires a system that can:

- Process Standard Laptop orders through the Service Catalog.
- Use an automated workflow for the procurement process.
- Generate a Catalog Task after the required approval.
- Assign the generated task to the Hardware team.
- Provide the required laptop configuration details in the task.
- Reduce manual intervention and waiting time.

4. Functional Requirements

The system should provide the following functions:

4.1 Standard Laptop Ordering

The system should provide a **Standard Laptop** catalog item through the Service Catalog so that a user can place a laptop request.

4.2 Service Catalog Trigger

The Flow should use a **Service Catalog trigger** to start the automated process.

4.3 Catalog Task Creation

The Flow should use the **Create Catalog Task** action to automatically create a Catalog Task.

4.4 Task Configuration

The generated Catalog Task should contain:

- **Short Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- **Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- **Assignment Group:** Hardware
- **Approval:** Approved

4.5 Flow Assignment

The Standard Laptop catalog item should be associated with the **Standard Laptop Task** Flow through the Process Engine configuration.

4.6 Task Verification

The generated Catalog Task should allow verification of its status, Short Description and Assignment Group.

5. Non-Functional Requirements

The project is intended to improve:

- Process efficiency
- Reduction of manual intervention
- Task allocation

- Resource utilisation
- Productivity
- Timely laptop configuration

These improvements are part of the project's stated objectives.

6. ServiceNow Components Required

The project requires the following ServiceNow components:

- **ServiceNow Flow Designer**
- **Service Catalog**
- **Standard Laptop Catalog Item**
- **Service Catalog Trigger**
- **Create Catalog Task Action**
- **Process Engine**
- **Catalog Task**
- **Hardware Assignment Group**

7. Expected System Behaviour

The expected workflow is:

Standard Laptop Order → Approval → Flow Execution → Catalog Task Creation → Hardware Assignment

After the Standard Laptop request is approved, the configured Flow should create the required Catalog Task and assign it to the Hardware group.

8. Expected Outcome

The expected outcome is an automated Standard Laptop procurement workflow that reduces manual task creation and assignment.

The automation should help provide timely configuration, reduce waiting time and improve task allocation and overall procurement efficiency.

9. Conclusion

The Requirement Analysis identifies the main requirements needed to implement the Standard Laptop procurement automation in ServiceNow.

The identified requirements provide the basis for designing and developing the Flow Designer workflow, connecting it with the Standard Laptop catalog item, and automatically creating the required Catalog Task for the Hardware team.